

How to help your child to study

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These are NOT helpful or useful.

“Just study more.”

“Just study harder.”

“You’re not studying enough!”

**This is helpful and useful:
You can do hard things!**

Assorted Facts & Advice

- As a parent
 - Ask child what's going on in class: homework, upcoming tests
 - Follow-up on instructions “to study”
- Useful facts
 - Note-taking in class – good for learning and reviewing
 - Read Math books
 - Studying is Active
 - Underlining is not useful - passive
 - Highlighting is not useful – passive
 - Learn to use mnemonics (e.g., HOMES)
 - Music/TV is usually not good (normal “noise” of home is ok)

Topics Covered

- Memory
- Study Skills
- Personal Beliefs about studying

Memory

- Physiology – memory cells
- Rehearsal
- Memorization vs Elaboration

Neurons and Learning

- “Learning” produces new connections between neurons
- “Learning” resurrects “dead” neurons
- Memorization and Elaboration
 - *Rehearsal* – builds & strengthens connections
 - *Memorization* – few new connections
 - *Elaboration* – many new connections

Nutrients for the brain

- **Diet and the Neurotransmitters**
 - Certain foods contain precursors (starting materials) for some neurotransmitters. ***If a diet is deficient in certain precursors, the brain will not be able to produce some neurotransmitters.*** Neurological and mental disorders may occur when the balance of neurotransmitters is upset. Examples of neurotransmitter precursors include:
 - **Aspartic Acid**
 - Used to make aspartate; found in ***peanuts, potatoes, eggs and grains.***
 - **Choline**
 - Used to make acetylcholine; found in ***eggs, liver and soybeans.***
 - **Glutamic Acid**
 - Used to make glutamate; found in ***flour and potatoes.***
 - **Phenylalanine**
 - Used to make dopamine; found in ***beets, soybeans, almonds, eggs, meat and grains.***
 - **Tryptophan**
 - Used to make serotonin; found in ***eggs, meat, skim milk, bananas, yogurt, milk, and cheese.***
 - **Tyrosine**
 - Used to make norepinephrine; found in ***milk, meat, fish and legumes.***
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Exercise and Sleep are also important.

Studying Strategies & Tactics

- Planning for tests
- Rehearsal/Planning
- Reading Textbooks

Planning for tests

- Know when the next tests are – if possible
 - try to learn about them 2-3 weeks in advance
- Review a little bit everyday
 - (cramming doesn't work well)
- Plan the review
 - create a study/review schedule
- Know what kind of test it is
 - MC, short-answer, essay, recall, performance
- Review and rehearse

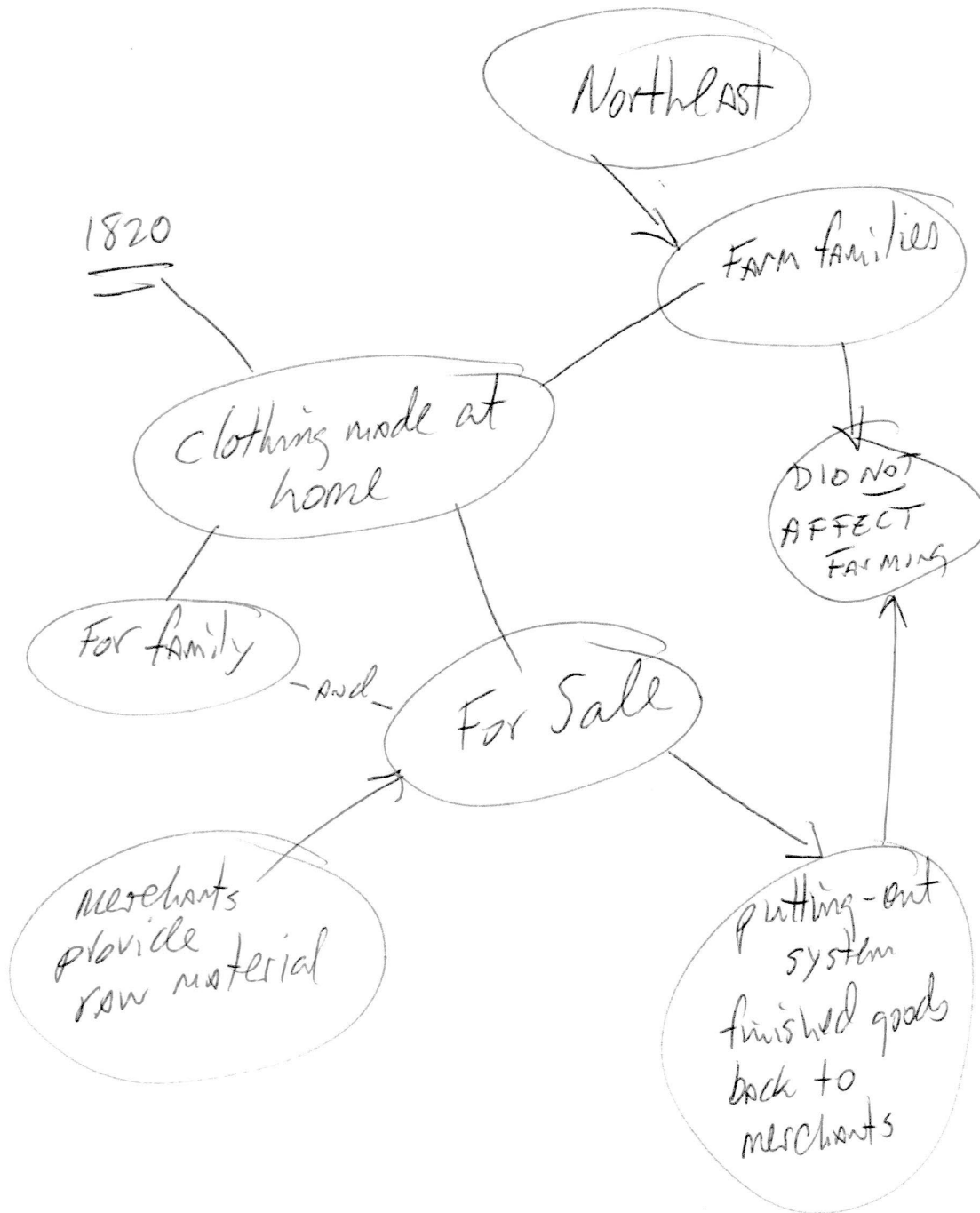
Reading a Textbook

- Be Active
- Underlining is not active
- Making notes in margins is active
- Text mapping is active
- Summarizing is active
- Discussion is active
 - Discuss at meal time
 - Study groups (?)

Text Mapping example

As late as 1820, about two thirds of the clothing worn by Americans was made entirely in households by female family members—wives & daughters. But a growing proportion was produced for market, rather than direct home consumption. Under the "putting-out system," manufacturing, merchant capitalists provided raw material to people in their own homes, picked up the finished or semi-finished products, paid the workers, and took charge of distribution. Besides textiles, items such as shoes and were made under the "putting-out system." Home manufacturing of this type was centered in the Northeast and often involved farm families making profitable use of their slack seasons. It did not usually present a direct challenge to the economic preeminence of agriculture or seriously disrupt a rural pattern of life.

Text map from text
book material



Beliefs about Learning

- Fixed ability – incorrect belief
- Quick Learning – incorrect belief

Coaching, encouragement, training, teaching, practicing of study skills, strategies, and habits will NOT make any difference if student has incorrect core beliefs.

Belief in Fixed Ability

- Intelligence (for example, IQ) is fixed – never changes – False
- “I’ll never be good at math.”
- “I just can’t write well.”

As a parent – don’t allow your child to talk or think in these terms.

Ability is NOT fixed. You can learn to learn. You can become better; you can become “smarter.”

You can do hard things!

Belief in Quick Learning

- “It makes no sense. I just don’t get it.”
- Common with Math & Arithmetic
 - If the answer isn’t obvious or you can’t see how to start, you don’t even try.

As a parent – don’t allow your child to talk or think in these terms.

Persistence and Perseverance

May be related to sleep, nutrition, and ability to focus.

You can do hard things!

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